



sqail

User Manual

A fast, small, open-source SQL editor that makes AI-assisted querying feel native. PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, and SQL Server — one editor.

[Version 0.6.5](#) · [Getting-started guide](#)

Welcome

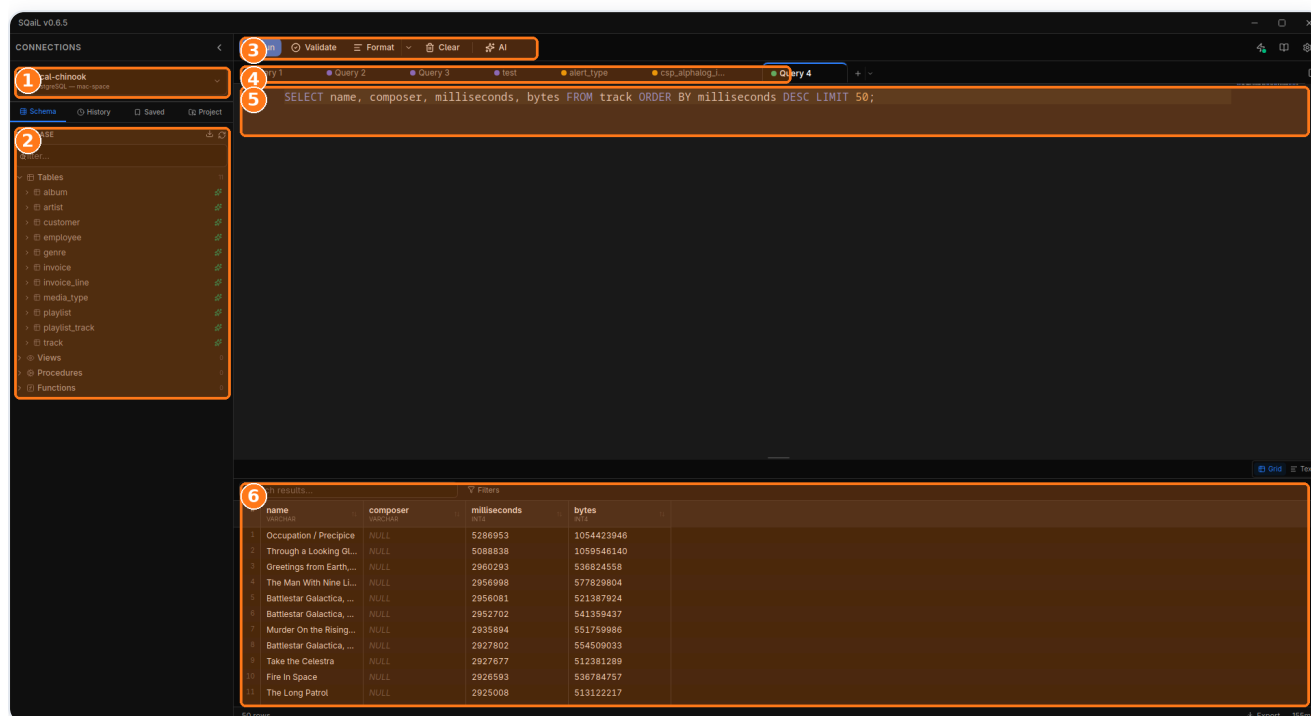
This guide walks you through the essentials of sqail — connecting to a database, writing and running queries, browsing your schema, and using the built-in AI assistant. Each section pairs a labelled screenshot with a short walkthrough.

1. **1.** The sqail interface
2. **2.** Connecting to a database
3. **3.** Writing & running queries
4. **4.** Browsing the schema
5. **5.** The AI assistant
6. **6.** Configuring AI providers
7. **7.** Inline AI completion
8. **8.** Settings & preferences
9. **9.** Keyboard shortcuts

Private by design. Credentials are stored locally in encrypted form and there is no telemetry. AI providers are only ever contacted once you configure them.

1 The sqail interface

The main window is split into a left workspace sidebar and a right editing area. Everything you need is one click away.

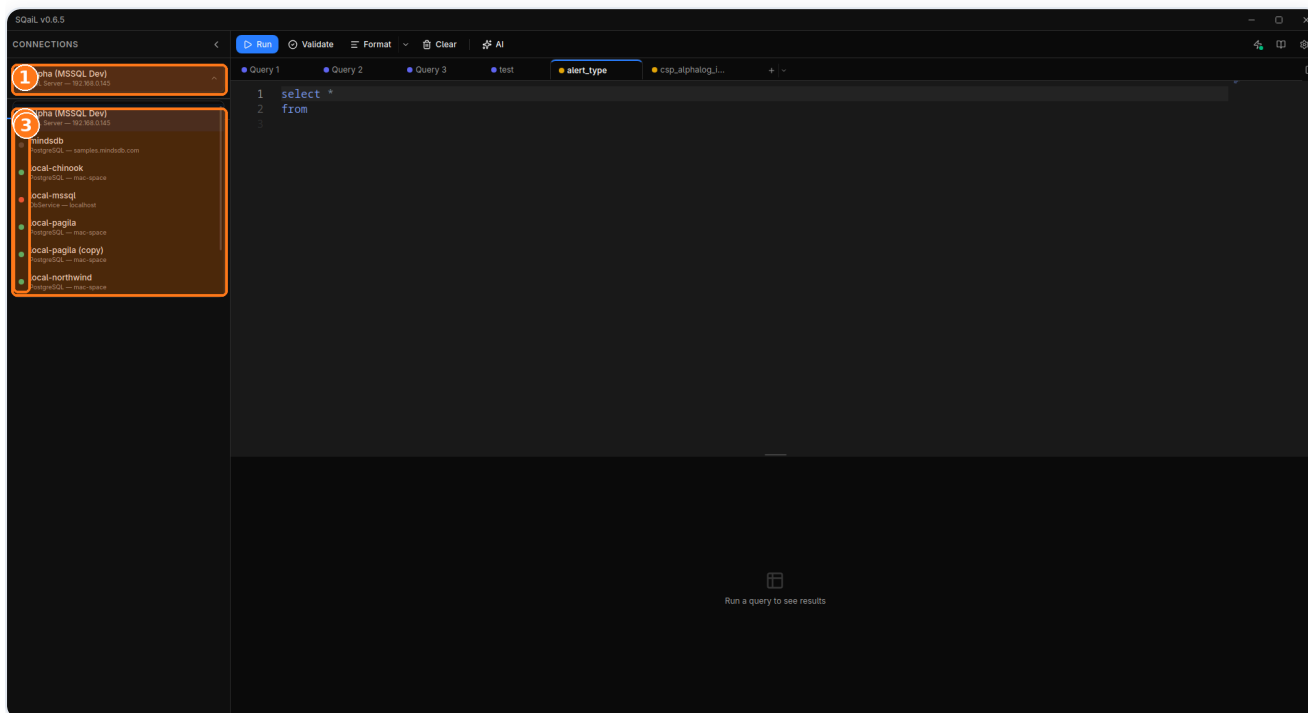


The sqail main window with a query run against a PostgreSQL sample database.

- 1 Connection switcher** — shows the active database; click to pick another saved connection.
- 2 Schema browser** — Tables, Views, Procedures and Functions for the current database, with a quick filter.
- 3 Action toolbar** — Run, Validate, Format and Clear the query, plus the AI assistant.
- 4 Query tabs** — keep several queries open at once; the `+` opens a new tab.
- 5 SQL editor** — the Monaco editor (the same one used by VS Code) with schema-aware autocomplete.
- 6 Results panel** — query output as a grid, with search, filters, and export.

2 Connecting to a database

sqail speaks PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite and Microsoft SQL Server. Saved connections live in the switcher at the top of the sidebar.

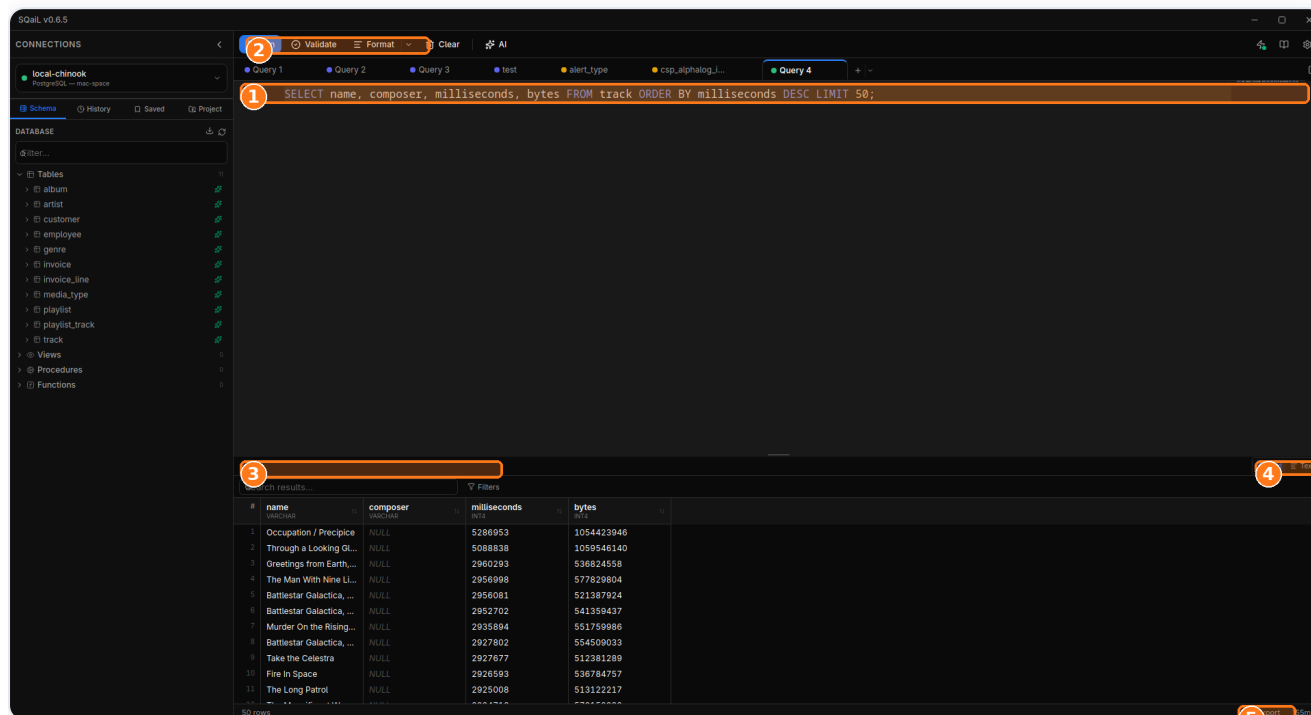


Click the connection switcher to reveal all saved connections.

- 1 **Active connection** — click it to open the list below.
 - 2 **Saved connections** — select any entry to connect; its engine and host are shown beneath the name.
 - 3 **Status dot** — green means connected, grey disconnected, red an error.
1. Open the connection switcher and choose a saved database, or add a new one.
 2. Once the dot turns green, the schema browser fills with that database's objects.
 3. Each query tab remembers the connection it was last run against.

3 Writing & running queries

Type SQL in the editor and run it against the active connection. Results appear in the panel below.



A query returning 50 rows in 155 ms.

- 1 **Write your SQL** here — autocomplete suggests tables and columns as you type.
- 2 **Run** executes the query (or `Ctrl/Cmd + Enter`); **Validate** and **Format** sit beside it.
- 3 **Search & Filters** — narrow the result set without re-running the query.
- 4 **Grid / Text** — switch between the table grid and a raw text view.
- 5 **Export** the results, with the row count and run time shown in the status bar.

Tip. If a query fails, sqail shows the database error inline with a **Fix with AI** button that asks the assistant to repair the statement for you.

4 Browsing the schema

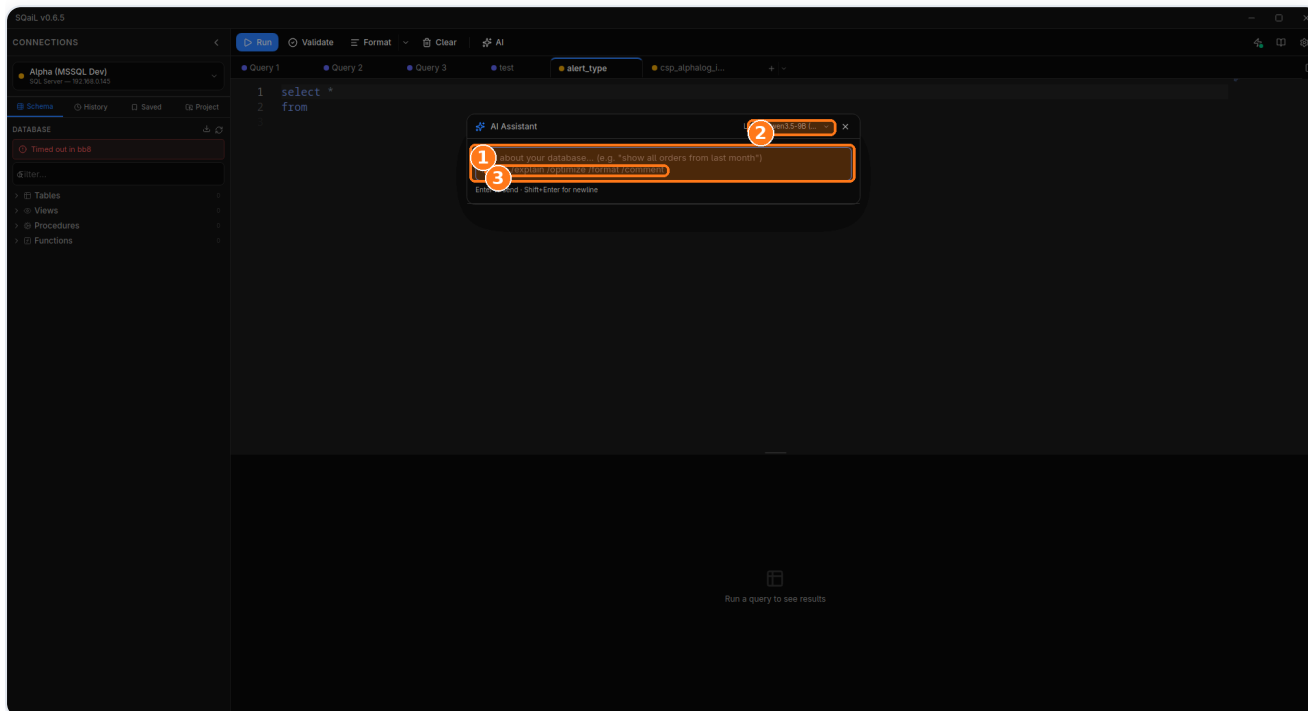
The schema browser (left sidebar, marker 2 in section 1) lists every object in the connected database, grouped into **Tables**, **Views**, **Procedures** and **Functions**.

1. Use the **Filter...** box to jump to an object by name.
2. Expand a table to see its columns, types and keys.
3. The counts beside each group (e.g. `Tables 11`) tell you how many objects it holds.
4. Switch the sidebar tabs between **Schema**, **History**, **Saved** queries and **Project**.

Autocomplete knows your schema. Because sqail reads the live schema, editor suggestions include your actual table and column names — not just SQL keywords.

5 The AI assistant

Click **AI** in the toolbar to open the assistant. Ask in plain English, or use a slash command to act on the current query.

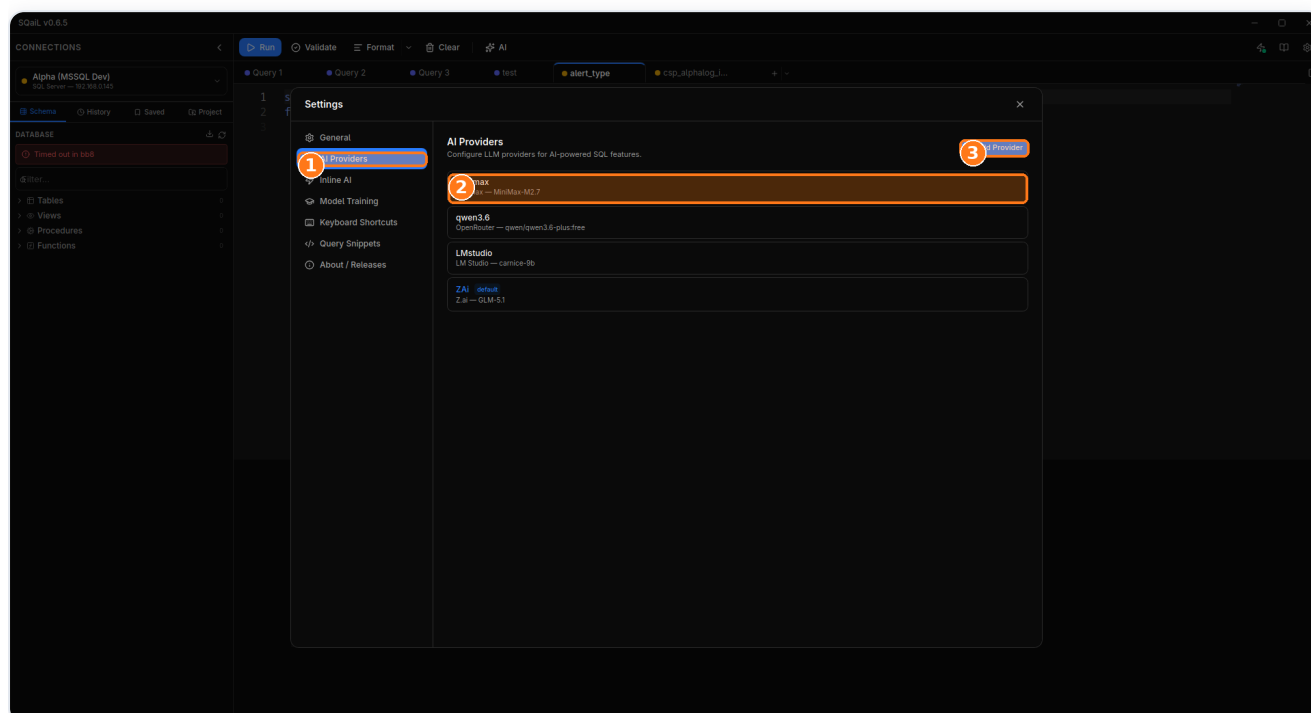


The AI assistant turns natural language into SQL — and explains, optimises, or formats existing queries.

- 1 **Prompt box** — describe what you want, e.g. *"show all orders from last month"*, and press `Enter`.
- 2 **Model selector** — choose which configured provider/model answers.
- 3 **Slash commands** — `/explain`, `/optimize`, `/format` and `/comment` act on the query in the editor.

6 Configuring AI providers

Bring your own key. sqail works with Claude, OpenAI, Minimax, Z.ai, OpenRouter, LM Studio, the Claude Code CLI, or any OpenAI-compatible endpoint.

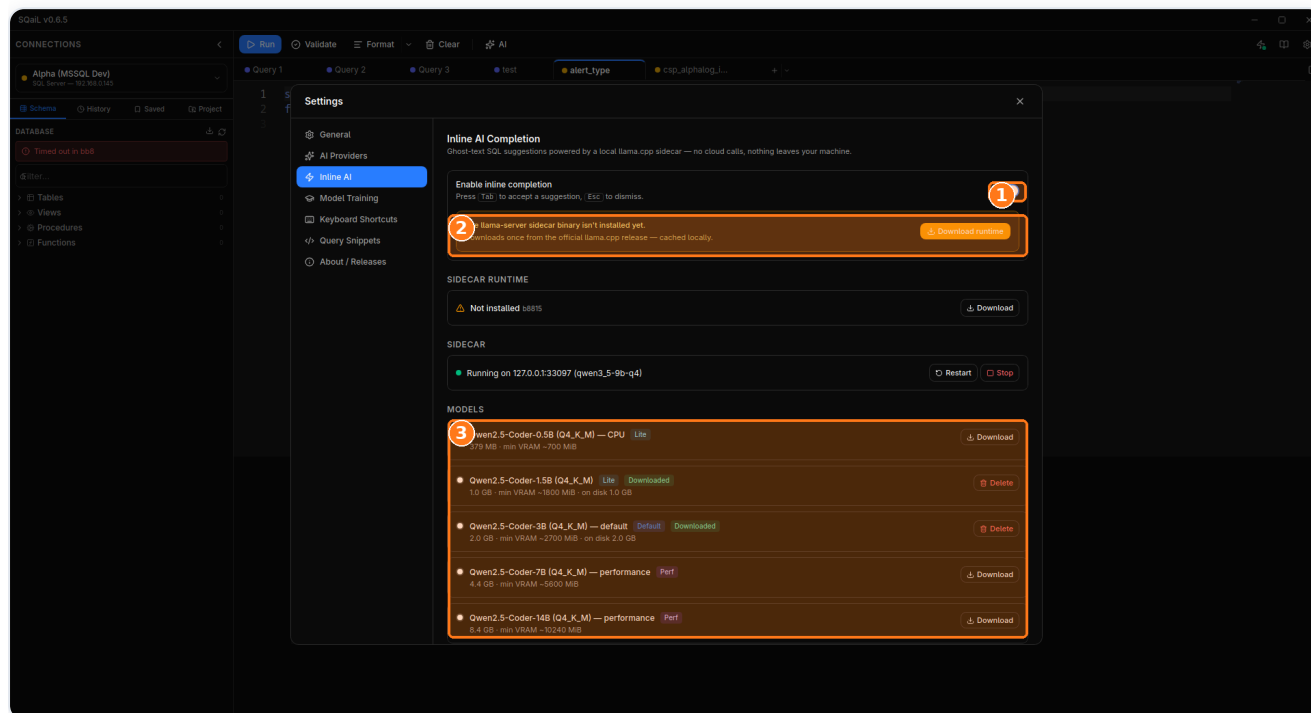


Settings → AI Providers, with several providers configured.

- 1 AI Providers** tab — open **Settings** (gear, top-right) and select it.
- 2 Configured provider** — each card shows the provider and model; one is marked *default*.
- 3 Add Provider** — register a new provider and paste your API key (stored locally).

7 Inline AI completion

Optional ghost-text SQL suggestions from a local llama.cpp model — nothing leaves your machine. Off by default until you switch it on.



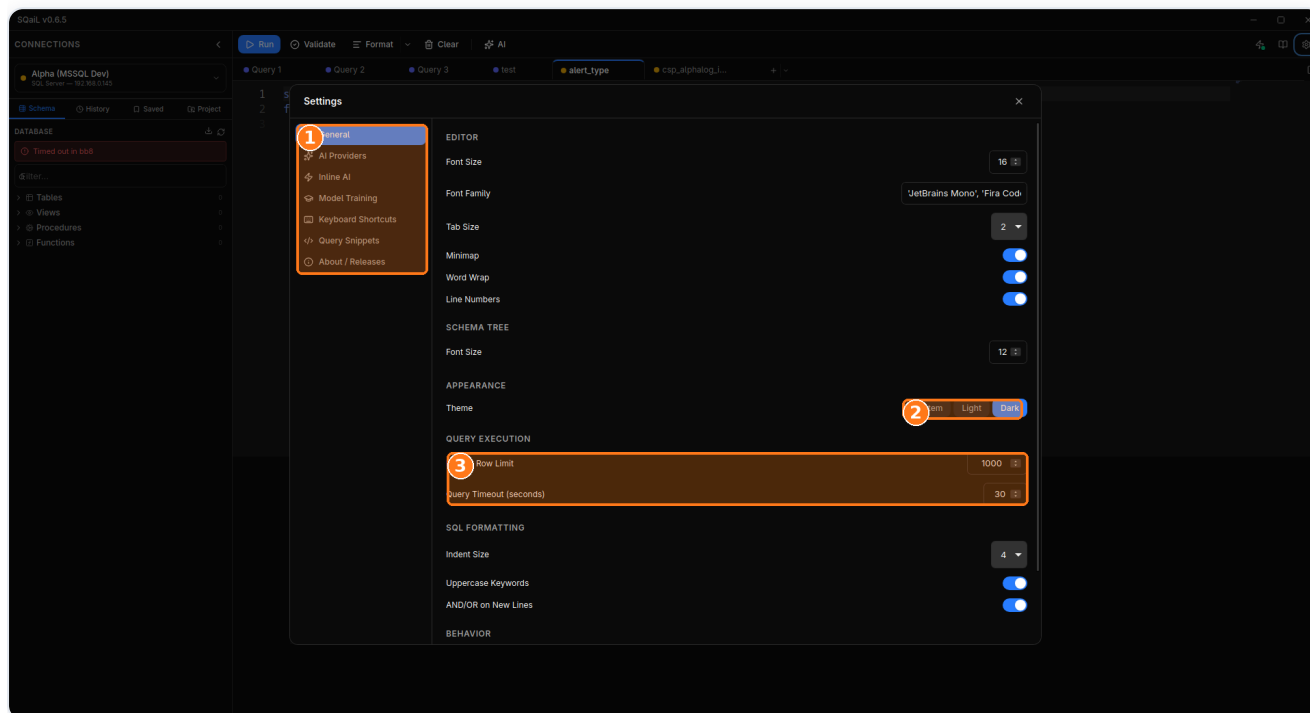
Settings → Inline AI: enable completion, fetch the runtime, and pick a model.

- 1 **Enable inline completion** — flip the toggle, then press `Tab` to accept a suggestion or `Esc` to dismiss it.
- 2 **Download runtime** — the local `llama-server` is fetched once and cached.
- 3 **Model catalog** — choose a model sized to your hardware (CPU-friendly to high-VRAM).

Fully local & opt-in. Nothing is downloaded or run until you enable the feature, and suggestions never make a network call.

8 Settings & preferences

Open **Settings** from the gear icon in the top-right corner to tune the editor, appearance and query defaults.



The General settings tab.

- Categories** — General, AI Providers, Inline AI, Model Training, Keyboard Shortcuts, Query Snippets and About.
- Theme** — follow the system, or force Light / Dark.
- Query execution** — set the default row limit and query timeout.

Other General options include editor font size and family, tab size, minimap, word wrap, line numbers, and SQL formatting rules (indent size, uppercase keywords, AND/OR placement).

9 Keyboard shortcuts

sqail is keyboard-first, and every binding is customisable under **Settings → Keyboard Shortcuts**. Common defaults:

Action	Shortcut
Run query	F5 (or Ctrl/Cmd + Enter in the editor)
Validate query	Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + V
Format query	Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + F
New tab	Ctrl/Cmd + N
Close tab	Ctrl/Cmd + W
Save query	Ctrl/Cmd + S
Open query	Ctrl/Cmd + O
New connection	Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + N
AI command palette	Ctrl/Cmd + K
Toggle AI settings	Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + A
Open settings	Ctrl/Cmd + ,
Accept inline suggestion	Tab
Dismiss inline suggestion	Esc

These are the built-in defaults. On macOS, **Ctrl** maps to **Cmd**. Every binding can be changed under **Settings → Keyboard Shortcuts**.

sqail is open source (MIT). · sqail.io · This guide covers version 0.6.5.